



WHAT'S DONE

- Eight quick reaction teams have been created
- Mumbai Police has augmented its budget, weapons and vehicles
- ATS to investigate all terror-related cases

WHAT'S NOT

- Coastal police stations yet to see the light of the day
- Force One on lines of NSG created but still homeless
- Recruitment rules for personnel for patrol boats still to be done

these stations are in various stages of construction while four are still in the process. We have 43 trawlers patrolling the waters." Also, 4,000 identity cards have been distributed to fishermen. "We are emphasising heavily on community-based interaction. Our motive is to involve civilians in the security process," she adds. Where the coastal policing may be lacking, the state government has attempted to make up with the formation of a 216-strong commando force, called Force One, along the lines of the NSG.

The orders for the formation of the force were passed on April 2, 2009. Of the total 352 posts sanctioned for the force, 256 posts have been created under the Action Group, while 94 have been earmarked for Technical and Administrative purposes. Of these, 216 commandos have already completed their training at Vadachi Vadi, Pune. The force is equipped with state-of-the-art weaponry like AK-47 assault rifles, MP 5 sub machine guns and Glock pistols. The Force One commandos have been trained in the use of explosives as well. "They have been trained by the best in the business from across the world. Each commando has undergone rigorous training and has passed out after meeting over 30 criteria set aside for them," says S. Jagannathan, DIG Force One.

However, though the training for the Force One commandos has been completed, the officers and men have to travel some distance for their daily training sessions. Stationed in Mumbai, the commandos are currently housed in temporary quarters. While 80 acres of land have been earmarked for the actual head quarters of Force One, the construction is yet to begin and will take at least one more year to complete.

by Swati Mathur

Reaction Team, up from 35 since last year.



■ Kasab in court

SHOWCASE TRIAL

Despite full speed, justice is still months away

With all eyes on the first anniversary of India's worst terror attack, 26/11 will hold a special significance for special public prosecutor Ujjwal Nikam this year too. Even after examining 253 witnesses over 170 days, the case against prime accused Ajmal Amir Kasab, is nowhere near conclusion. Nikam, who wants to conclude the prosecution case by November 26, says, "I have to set an example. I have to prove that even a case with international ramifications can be concluded effectively and efficiently."

On trial on several charges, including waging war against India, Kasab can face a death sentence or life imprisonment. In the interim months since the trial began, Kasab has also transformed from an arrogant youngster to a depression-ridden individual. Staying in solitary confinement in Mumbai's Arthur Road Jail, he is now a shadow of his former self, preferring to hang his head and sit in court. Though his lawyer Abbas Kazmi describes Kasab as a man who has given up, Nikam dismisses his transformation as the wily moves of a "cunning fox", playing a shrewd game.

by S.M.

WHAT'S DONE

- 86 charges framed against Kasab, of which waging war against the country invites the greatest punishment
- Prosecution has examined over 154 witnesses

WHAT'S NOT

- Trial isn't speedy: more prosecution witnesses are to be examined
- Judgement likely to take nearly two more months